BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha®
Satsang Development Committee
Yuvak-Yuvati Mandal
230 Aldington Road, Kemps Creek NSW 2178 Australia | Tel: +61 2 6535 2277 | Email: yuva.pravrutti@au.baps.org

|| Shri Swaminarayano Vijayate ||

AKSHAR-PURUSHOTTAM UPASANA PRAVARTAN

YODDHAS – NATIONAL SEVA FRAMEWORK

Vision • Structure • Roles • Responsibilities • Vicharan Planning

Fulfilling P.P. Mahant Swami Maharaj's Divine Sankalp

Vision and Purpose

- P.P. Mahant Swami Maharaj has made a divine sankalp to prepare more than 200 dedicated Yoddhas to spread Akshar-Purushottam Upasana across the Pacific region.
- Approximately 225 Yuvaks and Yuvatis have expressed their readiness to participate in this initiative. To fulfil this sankalp effectively, a structured National Team framework has been established to coordinate travel, plan Sabha and outreach activities, provide logistical support, and clearly define the responsibilities of both the National Team and individual Yoddhas.
- The objective is to ensure that every visit creates a meaningful and lasting impact on the local Satsang community.

Part A: National Team Structure and Responsibilities

1. Vicharan Allocation Lead

- **Primary responsibility:** To determine which Yoddhas will visit which centres and coordinate the planning of each Vicharan trip.

A. Yoddha and Centre Allocation

- Decide which Yoddhas will be assigned to each centre.
- Consider the Yoddhas' visa status and travel eligibility before allocating centres.
- Assess whether a particular centre requires financial assistance or additional support.
- Where appropriate, identify ways to provide assistance to centres that need additional support.

B. Collecting Centre Information

- Before finalising the visit, collect relevant information about the centre, including:
  - Number of Satsangi families.
  - Number of non-Satsangi families and interested individuals.
  - Number of Gujarati-speaking families.

- Number of Hindi-speaking families.
- Specific needs, opportunities and challenges at the centre.
- Potential participants for Sabha, Goshthi, home visits and children's activities.

- This information will help the team plan suitable activities based on the local community's needs.

C. Initial Planning Meeting

- Before every trip, arrange an initial planning meeting involving:
  - The local Sant.
  - The Regional Satsang Admin.
  - The Mandal Sanchalak.
  - The National Team.
- The meeting should determine the objectives of the visit, proposed activities, local requirements, responsibilities and expected outcomes.

D. Feedback and Evaluation

- At the end of every trip, ensure that the following two feedback forms are completed:
  1. **Yoddha Feedback Form:** To capture the Yoddha's experience, observations, challenges and suggestions.
  2. **Local Karyakar Feedback Form:** To understand the benefits of the Yoddha's visit, the impact on the centre and opportunities for future follow-up.

E. Local Sabha and Goshthi Arrangements

- Before the visit, communicate with the local mandal and clarify:
  - Whether meals will be arranged for attendees following a Sabha.
  - Whether meals will be arranged following a Goshthi.
  - Whether a microphone and sound system will be available.
  - Any additional arrangements required for the programme.
- All such arrangements should be communicated to the local mandal in advance.

2. Logistics Lead

- **Primary responsibility:** To coordinate accommodation, meals, transport and venue arrangements for every Yoddha trip.

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A. Accommodation and Meals

- Determine where the Yoddhas will stay during the visit.
- Confirm whether accommodation can be arranged by the local mandal.
- Confirm meal arrangements for the duration of the trip.
- Communicate the arrangements to the Yoddhas before departure.

B. Transport

- Determine whether a vehicle will be available locally.
- If a vehicle is unavailable, establish whether a rental car will be required.
- Clarify who will arrange and manage the vehicle.
- Communicate any expected rental or transport costs in advance.

C. Sabha Venue

- Coordinate with the local mandal to identify suitable venues for Sabha and Goshthi.
- Confirm venue availability, capacity and basic facilities.
- Ensure that venue arrangements align with the planned programme.

D. Advance Coordination

- All logistics should be confirmed before the Yoddhas depart, wherever possible, to minimise uncertainty and ensure smooth execution.

3. Sabha Programme Lead

- **Primary responsibility:** To prepare structured and engaging programmes for Sabha, Goshthi and other Upasana Pravartan activities.

A. Sabha Programme Planning

- Prepare a standard programme framework that can be adapted to the requirements of individual centres.
- Suggested topics include:
  - Jeevan Shuddhi – Purity and improvement in personal life.
  - Parivarik Shanti – Peace and harmony within the family.
  - Guru Mahima – The glory and importance of the Guru.
  - Bal Sanskar – Instilling values and spirituality in children.

  - Bhagwan No Ashro – Developing faith in and dependence upon Bhagwan.
  - Guru and Sanstha Introduction – Understanding the Guru Parampara and the BAPS organisation.
- Topics should be selected according to the needs, language preferences and spiritual understanding of the local audience.

B. Goshthi Programme Planning

- Prepare separate formats for the following two types of Goshthi:
  1. **Karyakar Goshthi:** To strengthen local karyakars, understand their challenges, provide guidance and encourage continued seva.
  2. **Mumukshu Goshthi:** To answer spiritual questions, deepen understanding of Satsang and Akshar-Purushottam Upasana, and develop personal connections.

C. Kirtan and Sankirtan

- Identify Yoddhas who have the ability to sing Kirtans.
- Where appropriate, incorporate Sankirtan into Sabha programmes.
- Use devotional singing to create an engaging and spiritually uplifting atmosphere.

D. Programme Resources

- Prepare and make available the required presentations, videos, discussion material and other resources for Yoddhas to use during their visits.

4. Administration and Records Lead

- **Primary responsibility:** To maintain central records, manage programme resources and ensure that the required material reaches the Yoddhas.

A. Resource Storage and Distribution

- Maintain a central repository of Sabha and Goshthi resources.
- Store presentations, videos and other programme material.
- Ensure Yoddhas can access and carry all required resources for their visits.
- Maintain organised records of the resources distributed and updated.

B. Sabha and Activity Records

- Maintain records of Sabha programmes conducted during each trip.

- Store relevant programme details and supporting documentation.
- Keep records of activities undertaken at each centre.

C. Video Interviews

- Coordinate and store video interviews recorded during visits.
- Maintain an organised archive of interviews and relevant recordings.
- Ensure that required consent is obtained before recording or using interviews.

D. Consent Forms

- Maintain the required consent forms for Yoddhas before their trips.
- Store completed forms securely.
- Ensure that the relevant documentation is available when required.

E. Inspiring Experiences and Prasangs

- Collect and store inspiring experiences from Yoddhas and local karyakars.
- Document meaningful outcomes and success stories from each trip.
- Organise these records so they can be shared for inspiration, training and future planning.

Part B: Collective Responsibilities of the National Team

1. Team Deployment and Trip Planning

- Each trip should generally include a group of **4–6 Yuvaks/ Yuvatis or 3 couples**, depending on the destination and programme requirements.
- The team should consider travel feasibility, centre requirements, visa eligibility and the expected scope of activities.
- Every trip should have clearly defined objectives, a programme plan and designated responsibilities.
- The National Team should coordinate with local Sants, Regional Satsang Admins and Mandal Sanchalaks before each visit.
- Feedback should be collected after each trip and used to improve future visits.

2. Development of Yoddhas

- The National Team will also be responsible for the ongoing spiritual and practical development of the Yoddhas.
- Two major initiatives should be organised at alternate year:
  1. **Annual Training Programme:** To develop the Yoddhas' understanding of Upasana, communication skills, programme delivery, personal sampark and practical seva skills.
  2. **Annual Yoddhas Conference:** To bring Yoddhas together to share experiences, discuss challenges, learn from successful initiatives, strengthen unity and renew their commitment to Swamishri's sankalp.

Part C: Responsibilities of Individual Yoddhas

1. Commitment and Participation

- Every Yoddha is expected to:
  - Commit to a minimum of **8 days** of participation in this initiative.
  - Complete the mandatory consent form before every trip.
  - Take responsibility for their assigned seva and complete it sincerely.
  - Coordinate with the local karyakars before, during and after the visit.
  - Participate actively in the planned programmes and outreach activities.
  - Complete the required feedback process after the trip.

2. Travel and Financial Responsibilities

A. Travel Costs

- Each Yoddha must bear their own travel expenses for every trip.
- If a visa is required, the Yoddha must arrange the necessary visa independently and ensure that they are eligible to travel.

B. Local Support and Arrangements

- Where possible, the local mandal may arrange:
  - Accommodation.
  - Meals.
  - A vehicle for local travel.
- However, these arrangements are subject to local availability and must be confirmed in advance.

- If the local mandal is unable to provide accommodation, meals or a vehicle, the Yoddha will be responsible for making their own arrangements and covering the associated costs, including rental car expenses where required.
- Yoddhas should clarify all arrangements before confirming their travel plans.

3. Ongoing Follow-up After the Trip

- The responsibility of a Yoddha does not end when the Vicharan trip concludes.
- Yoddhas are expected to remain in contact with the relevant local karyakars throughout the year, including periods when they are not undertaking a Vicharan trip.
- This ongoing connection should include:
  - Following up on individuals and families contacted during the visit.
  - Supporting local karyakars in maintaining relationships with mumukshus.
  - Encouraging continued participation in Sabha and other Satsang activities.
  - Providing guidance or assistance where appropriate.
  - Maintaining a connection with the centre and reviewing progress with the local karyakars.
- The aim is to ensure that each visit leads to sustained relationships and continued progress in Upasana Pravartan.

Part D: Yoddha: Responsibilities and Materials to be carried.

1. Sabha and Outreach Activities

- Depending on the requirements of the centre, the Yoddhas may undertake the following activities.

A. Satsang Sabha

- Conduct engaging Sabha programmes that introduce or strengthen understanding of Bhagwan Swaminarayan, the Guru Parampara, BAPS and Akshar-Purushottam Upasana.

B. Goshthi

- Conduct two types of Goshthi:
  - Karyakar Goshthi to strengthen and support local karyakars.
  - Mumukshu Goshthi to build relationships, answer questions and deepen spiritual understanding.

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C. Home Visits (Padharamani)

- Visit the homes of Haribhaktas and mumukshus to:
  - Strengthen personal relationships.
  - Understand their needs and questions.
  - Encourage regular participation in Satsang.
  - Provide opportunities for personal spiritual discussions.

D. Mahapuja or General Pujan Vidhi

- Conduct a Mahapuja where the Yoddhas have the necessary knowledge and ability. Otherwise, a suitable general Pujan Vidhi may be organised.

E. De-addiction Campaign

- Conduct awareness activities to encourage freedom from addictions and promote a disciplined, values-based lifestyle.

F. Bal Sabha

- Organise engaging children's activities focused on spiritual values, devotion, character development and Sanskar.
- Yoddhas should carry chocolates and Chupa Chups for children to make the Bal Sabha more enjoyable and engaging.

G. Prabhat/ Sandhya Pheri

- Where suitable and practical, organise a Prabhat Pheri to encourage devotional participation and increase awareness of Satsang in the local community.
- All activities should be planned in coordination with local leadership and adapted to the needs of the centre.

2. Items and Resources to Be Carried by Yoddhas

A. Sabha and Goshthi Materials

- Every Yoddha should carry the resources required for the planned programmes, including:
  - Sabha programme materials.
  - Goshthi discussion materials.
  - Relevant videos.
  - Presentation slides and other digital resources.
  - Any additional material communicated by the Sabha Programme Lead.

- Yoddhas should ensure that all digital content is accessible and ready to use before departure.

B. Spiritual Resources

- Yoddhas should carry the following, as appropriate:
  - Satsang Diksha.
  - Puja materials.
  - Kanthi.
  - All-in-One Murti.
  - A metal murti of Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj, wherever feasible.

C. Bal Sabha Materials

- Yoddhas conducting Bal Sabha should consider carrying suitable materials for children, including:
  - Chocolates or Chupa Chups lollipops.
  - Age-appropriate activity or engagement materials.
- Any distribution should be appropriate to the activity and local arrangements.

D. Dress Code

- Yoddhas should maintain a consistent, neat and appropriate appearance during their seva.
- The prescribed dress options are:
  - Black trousers with a white shirt.
  - Traditional jubbo and lengho attire.
  - Designated initiative T-shirt, where appropriate.
  - Padharamani bag for home visits.
- The dress should be selected according to the nature of the activity and any specific guidance provided by the National Team.

Part F: Suggested Vicharan Zones and Centres

- The following locations are potential areas for Vicharan planning. The final selection of centres for each trip should be determined by the National Team in consultation with local leadership, taking travel distances, centre needs and available time into account.

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1. Tasmania

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Hobart
  - Devenport
  - Launceston

2. Victoria Regional

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Ballarat
  - Geelong
  - Bendigo
  - Shepperton

3. NSW Regional 1

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Wagga Wagga
  - Albury
  - Griffith

4. NSW Regional 2

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Newcastle
  - Gosford
  - Port MacQuarrie

5. NSW Regional 3

- Potential destinations:
  - Wollongong
  - Mittagong
  - Nowra
  - Goulburn

6. NSW Regional 4

- Potential destinations:
  - Bathurst

- Dubbo
- Orange

7. QLD 1

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Gold Coast
  - Sunshine Cost
  - Toowoomba
  - Gatton

8. QLD 2

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Bundaberg
  - Gladstone
  - Rockhampton

9. QLD 3

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Cairns
  - Townsville
  - Mackay

10. South Australia

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Berri
  - Mount Gambier
  - Mildura
  - Wayla

11. Northern Territory

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Darwin
  - Alice Spring

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12. Western Australia

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Kalgoorlie
  - Bunbury
  - Mindura
  - Wellard

13. New Zealand 1

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Whangarei
  - Pukekohe
  - Hamilton
  - Rotorua

14. New Zealand 2

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Napier
  - Gisborne
  - Palmerston North
  - Levin

15. New Zealand 3

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Queenstown
  - Dunedin
  - Invercargill

16. New Zealand 4

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Nelson
  - Christchurch
  - Blenheim

17. Fiji 1

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Ba

- Nadi
- Lautoka

18. Fiji 2

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:
  - Suva
  - Labasa

19. PNG

- Potential centres and surrounding areas:

Part G: Implementation and Review

1. Recommended Trip Planning Process

- Every Vicharan trip should follow a clear and consistent process.

Before the trip

1. Identify the centre and confirm the Yoddha allocation.
2. Gather information about the local Satsang community and its needs.
3. Conduct the initial planning meeting with the local Sant, Regional Satsang Admin, Mandal Sanchalak and National Team.
4. Finalise the programme, venue, accommodation, meals and transport arrangements.
5. Confirm travel eligibility, complete consent forms and prepare all required resources.

During the trip

1. Conduct the planned Sabha, Goshthi, home visits and other activities.
2. Maintain coordination with local karyakars.
3. Record relevant activities and inspiring experiences.
4. Capture interviews only with the appropriate consent.
5. Identify individuals and families who require ongoing follow-up.

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After the trip

1. Complete both feedback forms: one from the Yoddha and one from the local karyakar.
2. Submit relevant programme records, interviews and inspiring experiences to the designated National Team repository.
3. Share key observations and recommendations.
4. Continue follow-up with local karyakars throughout the year.
5. Use the feedback to improve future Vicharan trips.

Our Collective Commitment

- Every member of the National Team, every Team Lead and every Yoddha has a significant role in fulfilling P.P. Mahant Swami Maharaj's divine sankalp.
- With clear responsibilities, thoughtful planning, effective coordination and continuous follow-up, we can ensure that each Vicharan trip becomes an opportunity to strengthen Satsang, build meaningful relationships and spread the glory of Akshar-Purushottam Upasana.
- **Our shared goal is to work with samp, suhradbhav, mahima and samarpan, becoming dedicated instruments in colouring the entire Pacific region with Akshar-Purushottam Bhakti.**

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